

APM Project Management Qualification

Learner Study Pack



Integrated Planning

Introduction

This section of the Learner Study Pack will cover the Integrated Planning competence of the APM Project Management Qualification.

This section will enable you to gain an understanding of the different components involved in creating an integrated plan and the importance of doing this for successful project delivery.

Learning objective and outcomes

Learning objective:

19. Understand integrated planning as the ability to incorporate multiple plans and processes into an integrated project management plan.

By the end of this activity, you should be able to:

19a) Know the format for an effective integrated project management plan and its typical contents.

19b) Understand the importance of producing an integrated project management plan.

Study time

This section of the Learner Study Pack will take approximately 1 - 2 hours to complete.

Recommended resources

In addition to your Learner Study Pack, use the below references for more information on Integrated Planning:

- APM Body of Knowledge Seventh edition, 4.2 (Integrated planning)
- APM Learning Module, Introduction to project planning Accessed at: <https://www.apm.org.uk/resources/apm-learning/>
- APM, Planning, Scheduling, Monitoring and Control - The Practical Project Management of Time, Cost and Risk
Accessed at: <https://www.apm.org.uk/resources/apm-learning/>
Accessed at: <https://www.apm.org.uk/book-shop/planning-scheduling-monitoring-and-control-the-practical-project-management-of-time-cost-and-risk/>
- APM What is project planning? Accessed at: <https://www.apm.org.uk/resources/what-is-project-management/what-is-planning/>

- APM Project Management Plan template. Accessed at:
<https://apm.unicornlms.com/UI/Home?refresh=true&path=%2FDocument%2FDetails%2F7786fb66-d9e6-4049-a703-aa2a010016ac>

Overview

Integrated planning is a strategic approach that combines various planning processes to enhance co-ordination, communication and project efficiency.

It brings together the planning of benefits, scope, quality, scheduling, budgets, risk, communications etc. into one key document, usually known as the Project Management Plan (PMP).

Project Management Plan (PMP)

The intention of the project management plan (PMP) is to capture the fundamental components to deliver project outcomes successfully.

It involves collating the suite of plans and processes that support a project to create an integrated plan (the PMP).

The size and complexity of a project will influence the amount of content in the PMP, and the format may also vary based on organisational ways of working and who's involved in the project.

Once the information is assembled in a self-contained document, it should integrate all the essential management processes needed to show the project teams' intentions of how the project will be managed.

The PMP should include the why, what, when, who, how much, where and how of a project.

Typical contents of a project management plan may include:

- **Benefits** – why?
Referencing the Business Case, looking at the value the project benefits will deliver the business once achieved.
- **Scope** – what?
Looking at descriptions of the scope involved, considering the Product Breakdown Structure (PBS) and Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) and detailing the acceptance criteria.
- **Time** – when?
Showing the timeline for project activities and deliverables aligned to the project life cycle approach.
- **Resources** – who?
Shows the roles and responsibilities and reporting lines presenting the Organisational Breakdown Structure (OBS).
- **Cost** – how much?
Showing how the budget has been allocated to the work for the project duration presenting the Cost Breakdown Structure (CBS)
- **Delivery Logistics** – where?
Detailing project location, delivery requirements, any environment constraints, technology to support virtual locations, or security protocols.

- **Management** – how?

The most wide-ranging part of the document outlining the management aspects for deployment covering areas such as quality, risk and issues, communication, and project controls.

Importance of an Integrated Project Management Plan (PMP)

An integrated Project Management Plan (PMP) ensures:

- Communication of the details of approved project plans to stakeholders.
- Key stakeholders involved in deployment of the project have been engaged with its production.
- Provision of a reference source for all stakeholders.
- Provision of one source of the truth to all resources involved and can be used as induction material for new members to ensure continuity to the project.
- Provision of a reference as the contract between the project manager and project sponsor providing clarity on what is expected of the project manager.
- Guidance for the project team and is the baseline for measurement and analysis of progress to take place.

Scenario One:

Considering the large-scale nature of the renovation of the Snappy Appy head office, Ayo wants to ensure that everything goes as smoothly as possible.

They are concerned that the combination of juggling multiple stakeholders, tight timeframes and deadlines, and a huge variety of interdependent tasks mean that the project is susceptible to going off track, causing delays and extra costs.

Ayo is a self-confessed 'Big Picture' thinker, so is looking for reassurance that there is an integrated plan that will ensure that the project is handled effectively.

What should you include in an integrated plan for the renovation project and why are those elements important?

Scenario Two:

After seeing that you have considered the complexities involved and allowed for potential changes, Ayo is totally bought into the need for the integrated plan and is very appreciative of the extent of the information that you've provided.

However, some elements within the Senior Leadership Team, think this kind of planning goes into too much detail and the project should just get underway.

Ayo has asked you to send them some information outlining how your integrated planning approach will ensure the overall success of the project.

How does producing an integrated project management plan support the project's success?

Learning review questions

Before you attempt the exam practice questions in the next section, we recommend you review your learning to quickly see which aspects you don't understand or can't remember as well.

It will also boost your confidence by confirming what you have learnt and your demonstrated ability to apply that knowledge, so that you are ready to practise for the exam.

For some of these questions, you may also find the Stakeholder Engagement and Communication Management competency useful.

Here are some questions you may wish to answer to review your learning from the Integrated Planning section:

- Which specific plans can exist in a PMP to cover management aspects?
- How might a PMP be used to gain stakeholder buy in to a project?
- How are the various ways that an integrated plan could be shared with a project team?
- Who are the various stakeholders that could be potentially involved in the creating of a PMP?

Exam practice questions

19.1 You are managing a project to build a new software application. During a project review, stakeholders are concerned that the baseline project plan does not consider how uncertainty is managed across the project.

Which three parts of integrated planning would help address this concern?
(1 mark)

1. Risk identification
2. Stakeholder engagement
3. Risk analysis
4. Contingency planning
5. Economic analysis
6. Resource optimisation

Select the correct combination:

- a. 1, 2, 5
- b. 1, 3, 4
- c. 2, 3, 6
- d. 2, 4, 5

19.2 Why is producing an integrated project management plan important in a linear project life cycle?
(1 mark)

- a. It simplifies the schedule by mapping out each phase of the project life cycle.
- b. It maintains focus on the schedule and budget throughout the project life cycle.
- c. It allows a baseline to be established from which the project can be managed and controlled.
- d. It ensures that the project manager is in complete control of the project deliverables.

19.3 The exact contents of a Project Management Plan may vary between projects due to the project's size, complexity and _____. **(a)** _____.

Typical contents of a Project Management Plan include the benefits, scope, timeline, project team organisation, budget and _____. **(b)** _____.

(2 marks)

(a)

1. Choice of life cycle
2. Project sponsor's preference
3. Project duration
4. Choice of solution

(b)

1. Detailed work plans
2. Management strategies
3. Design specifications
4. Relevant legal contracts

19.4 What are five reasons why it is important to produce an integrated project management plan?
(5 marks)

Exam practice answers

Question	Answer / Mark scheme
19.1	B
19.2	C
19.3	a) 1 b) 2
19.4	1 mark for any of the below or other correct reason, 5 marks in total: • Serves as a single point of reference for the project. • Allows clear communication of all important project details. • Can be used to help induct new project team members. • Serves as the contract between the project manager and project sponsor. • Gives clarity to the project manager on what is expected of them / the project. • Allows everyone to understand what the project is aiming to achieve, and how. • Makes sure that all relevant governance / strategies are documented. • Serves as the baseline for measurement of progress.